

Decision-making guide

Design Thinking Microsimulation

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1. Simulation platform introduction

1.1 Game Arena

The gaming arena interface comprises various decision tabs that includes the Introduction section, observe, Empathize, Define, ideate, Prototype, Execute, Decision Checklist, and Reports. Some sections must be completed first as they have an impact on other areas.

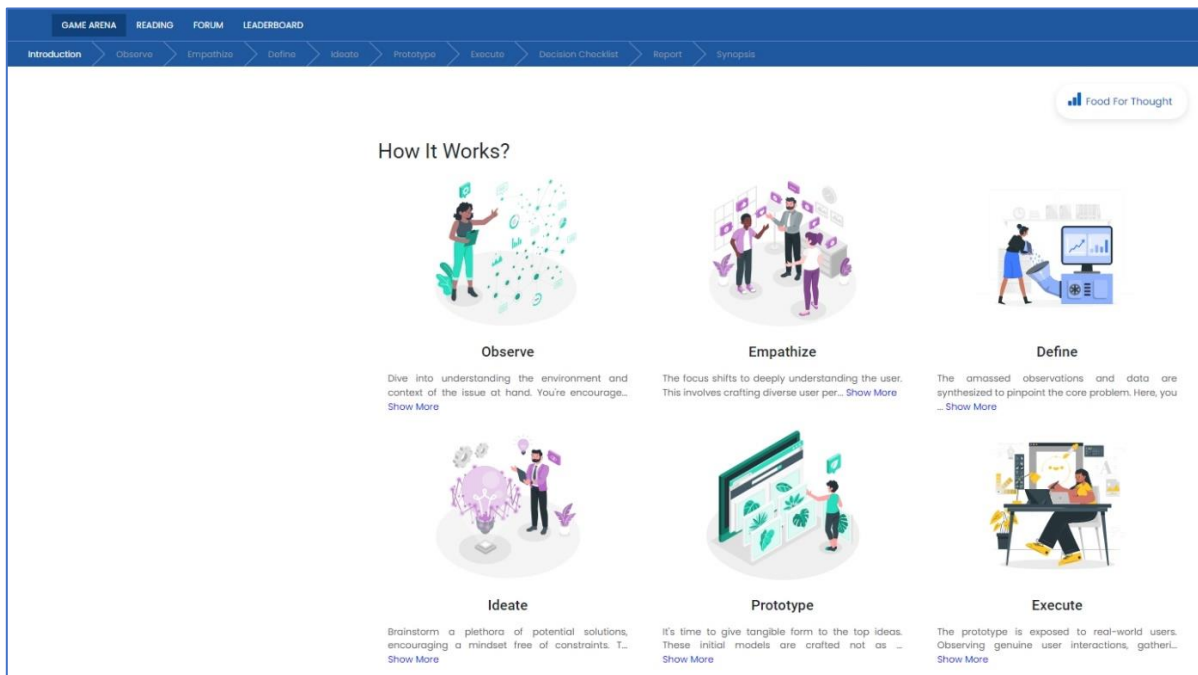


Figure 1 The Game Arena

1.2 Readings

This section provides essential materials necessary for participants to actively engage in the game. The main reading material consists of a guide for decision-making, supplemented by optional additional resources chosen by instructors. Moreover, a walkthrough video is accessible, offering in-depth information about the scenario featured in the simulation. This video presents insights into the case scenario, industry overview and the diverse array of decisions required.

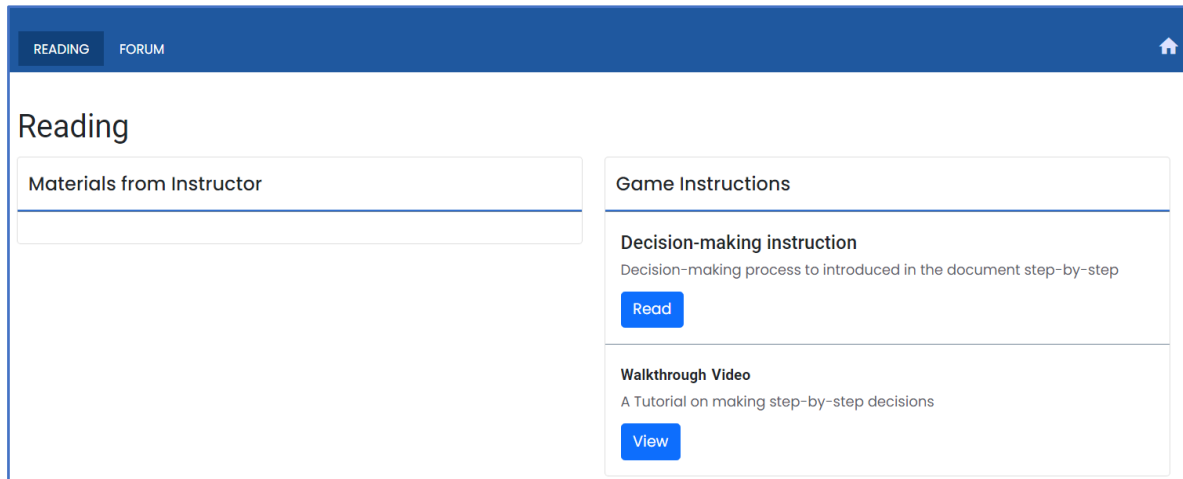


Figure 2 The Readings Section

1.3 Forum

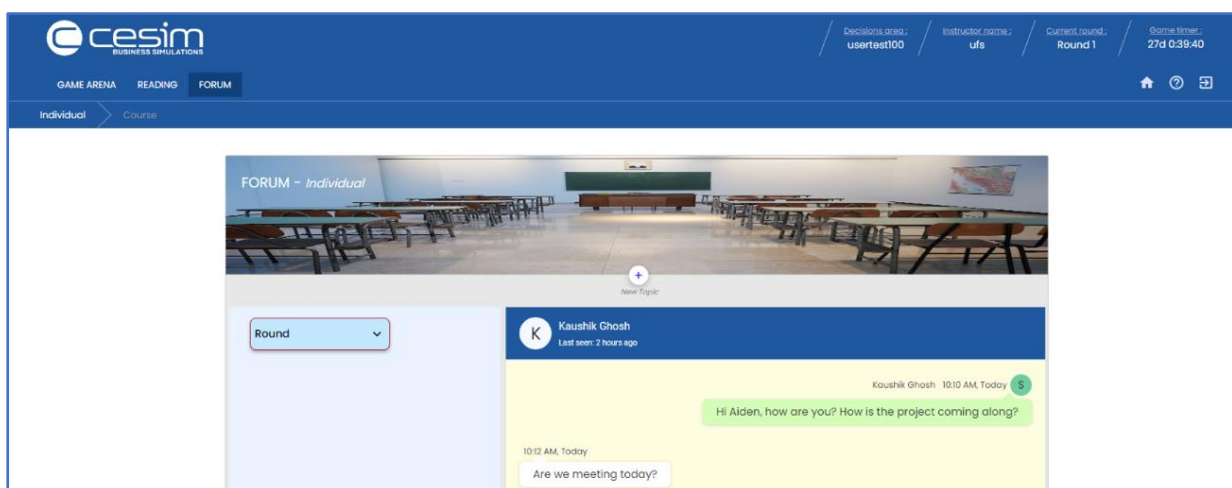


Figure 3 The Forum Section

- The forums provide an excellent platform for participants to engage with their instructors or peers.
- There are two separate forums: the Individual Forum and the Course Forum. The Individual Forum allows participants to communicate directly with the instructor, while the Course Forum is accessible to all enrolled players.
- Instructors can view and respond to posts in both sections. Consequently, the Course Forum is an appropriate space for asking questions that can benefit the entire course, while the Individual Forum is the preferred channel for the individual to have a direct discussion with the professor.
- Participants will receive notifications for messages.

1.4 Main Objective & Winning Criteria

TechTime Innovations, a decade-old electronics company founded by engineers from premier institutions, has established a strong presence with its fitness trackers and IoT devices. The company achieved a 20% market share for fitness trackers in urban India within three years and a 30% adoption rate for IoT devices in tier-1 cities, with Bengaluru and Mumbai leading the way. Customer demand highlights the need for an all-in-one wearable focused on health, fitness, and productivity.

Building on this success, TechTime is now expanding into the rapidly growing smartwatch market. Participants are tasked with identifying the opportunities TechTime Innovations can leverage and the challenges it may encounter in developing a user-centric smartwatch that resonates with Indian consumers. The end goal is to increase market share by 2% and achieve a profit margin of 8%.

1.5 Successful decision-making flow

The sequence of decision-making unfolds as follows:

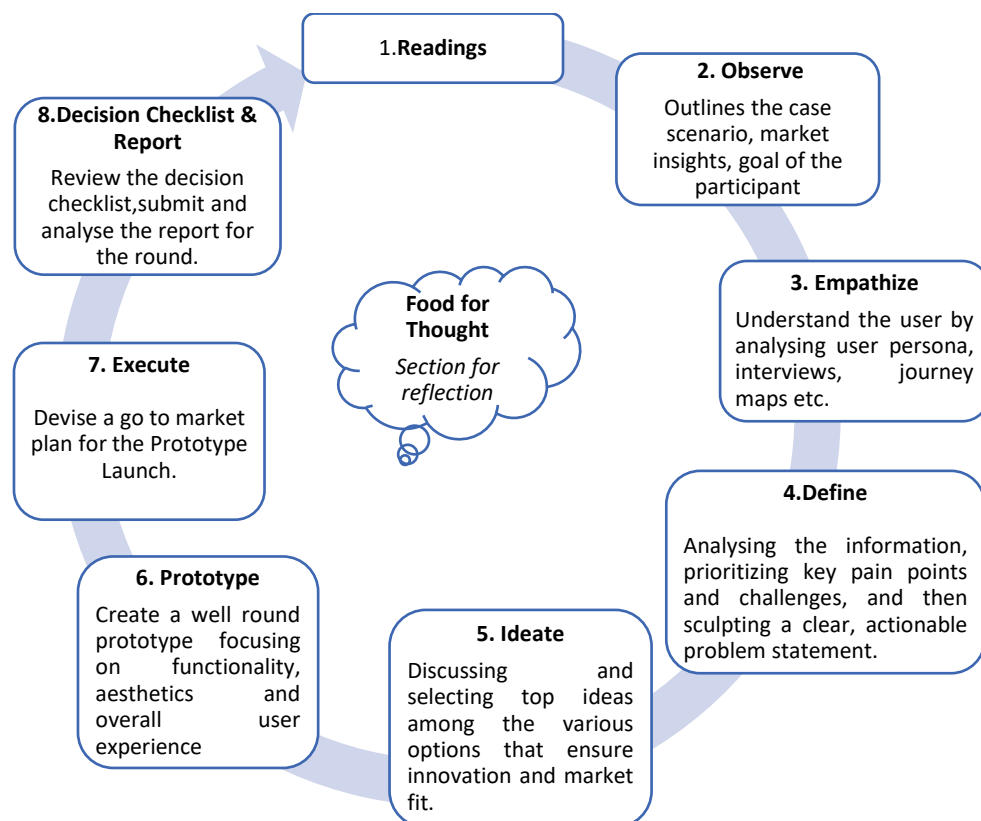


Figure 4 The Sequence of Decision-Making Process

2. Game Arena

2.1 Introduction

This page encompasses information detailing the functioning of the simulation and provides insights into each tab's decision-making.

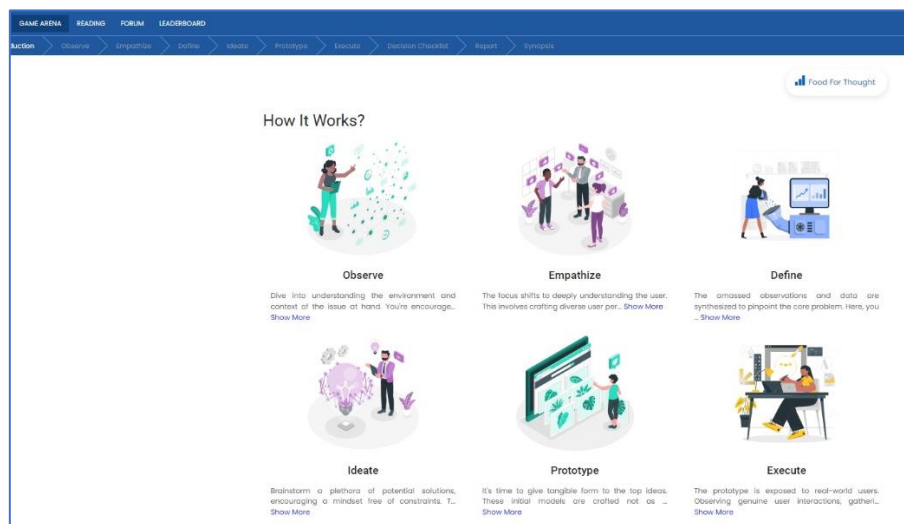


Figure 5 The Introduction Tab

2.2 Food for Thought

The "Food for Thought" section contains questions related to key decision areas, providing valuable insights to guide decision-making. Participants are encouraged to review it before addressing the decision areas, as it offers essential clarity on the decision-making process. Completion of this section is mandatory for Round one.

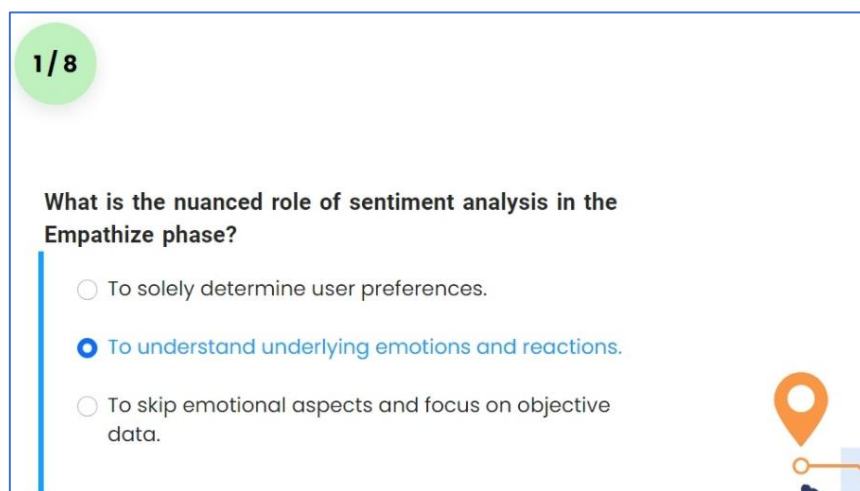


Figure 6 The Food for Thought Section

2.3 Observe

In this section, participants have data on the case scenario, including market insights, company challenges, and future strategic direction. Their task is to identify potential opportunities the company can leverage, as well as the challenges it may face in developing a user-centric smartwatch tailored to the preferences of Indian consumers.

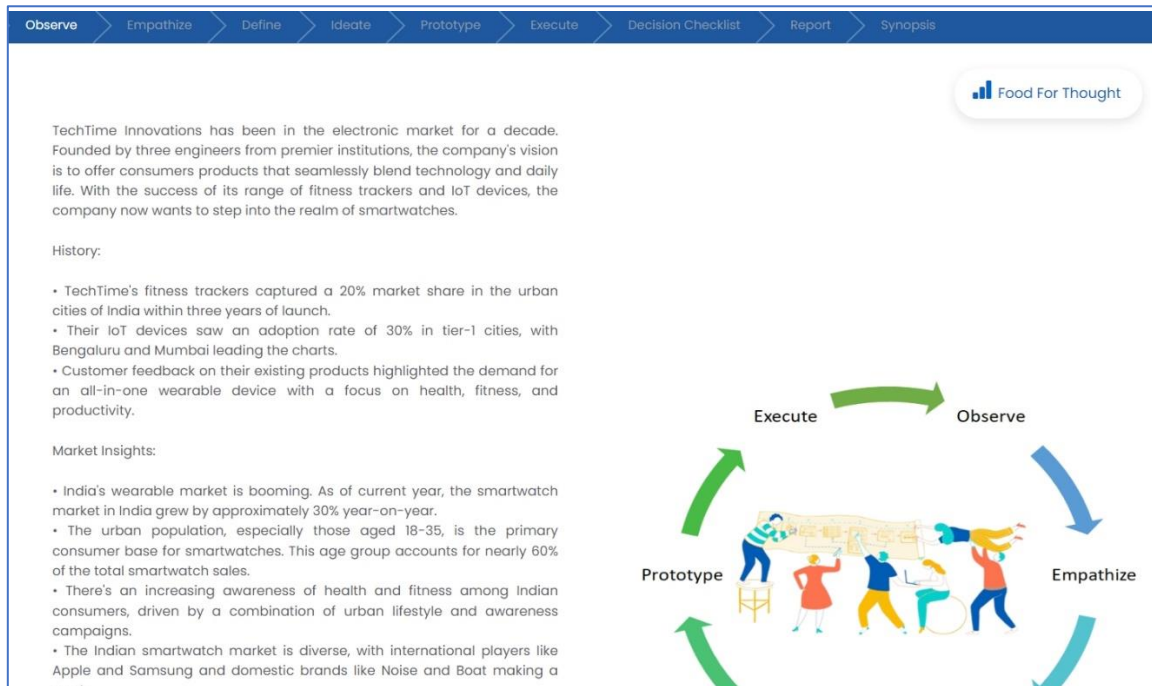


Figure 7 The Observe Tab in the Game Arena

2.4 Empathize

The Empathize tab offers comprehensive insights gathered from users, including user personas, interviews, journey maps, and sentiment analysis. The data captures key details such as users' occupations, goals, challenges, experiences, feature preferences, preferred purchase channels, and expectations for the product. This direct input helps identify pain points, unmet needs, and areas for improvement, driving more targeted and user-centric enhancements.

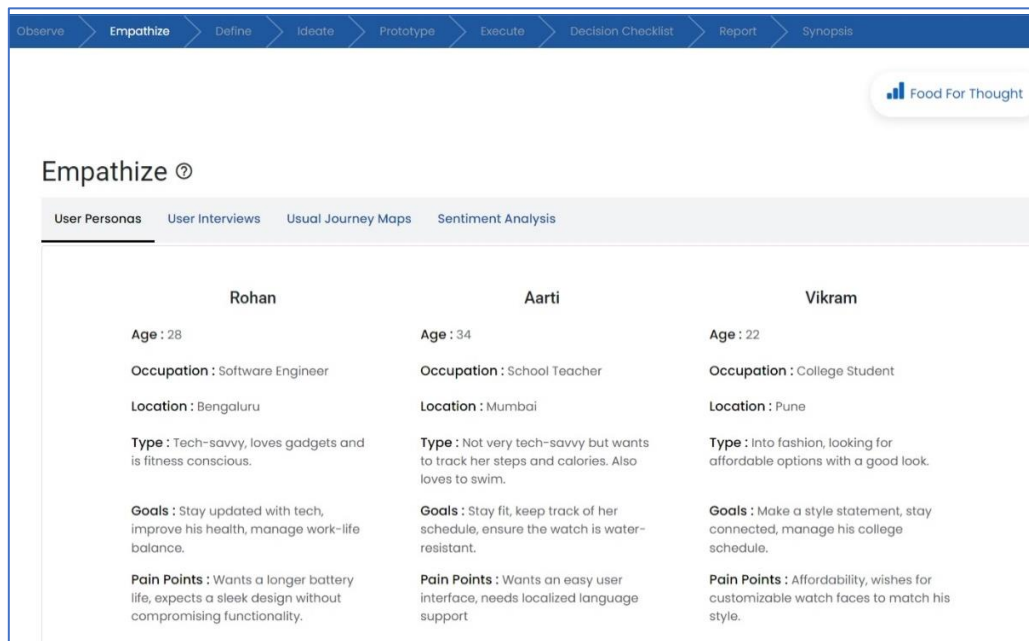


Figure 8 The Empathize Tab in the Game Arena

2.5 Define

In the Define tab, participants are tasked with reviewing the SWOT analysis and gap analysis to develop a product strategy. They must make critical decisions regarding battery life, affordability, and localization features to ensure the product addresses user needs based on the insights gathered. This strategic approach aligns the product design with market demands and user expectations, enhancing its chances for success.

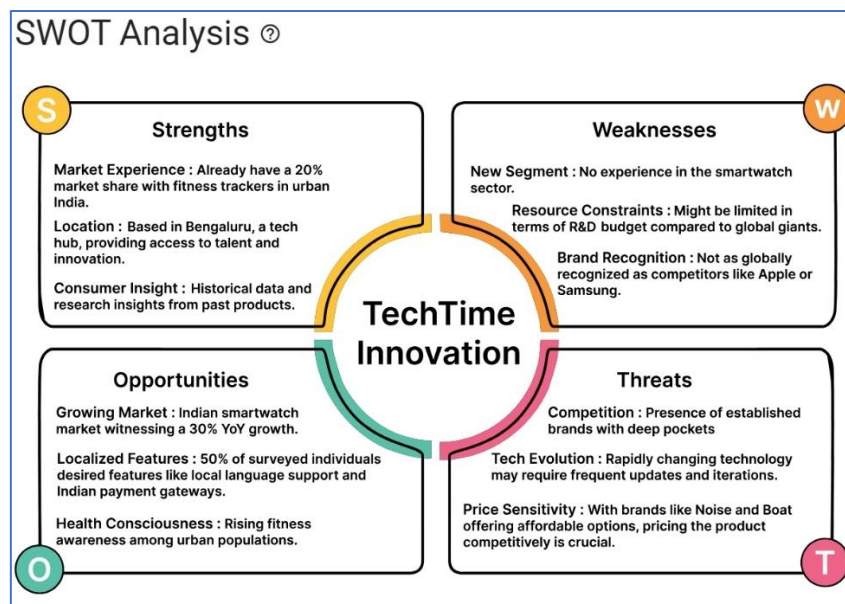


Figure 9 The Swot Analysis Provided in the Define Tab



Figure 10 The define tab in the Game Arena

2.6 Ideate

In this tab, participants must select the top three product ideas from the available options. While making their selections, they need to consider the features offered, the target segment, the closest competitors, and the rationale for why each product meets consumer requirements. This thoughtful approach ensures the chosen ideas align with market needs and competitive dynamics.

Ideate | Prototype | Execute | Decision Checklist | Report | Synopsis

Food For Thought

Ideate

TechTime Vital+

Features : Advanced health metrics, Ayurvedic wellness insights, ECG, regional health advisories.

Target Segment : Health-conscious adults, especially from urban areas like Bengaluru.

Closest Competitor : Apple Watch Series 6 (Market Share : 30%, Revenue: INR 15,000 Crore).

Context : Rising health consciousness among urban Indians.

TechTime Linguist

Features : Support for multiple Indian languages, instant translation, cultural event reminders, advisories.

Target Segment : Multilingual professionals and seniors who prefer regional languages.

Closest Competitor : Garmin Venu (Market Share: 10%, Revenue: INR 3,500 Crore).

Context : 50% of users desired localized features.

TechTime Eco

Features : Solar-powered, carbon footprint tracker, sustainability tips tailored for Indian users.

Target Segment : Environmentalists and the young urban population.

Closest Competitor : Garmin Fenix 6X Pro Solar (Market Share: 8%, Revenue: INR 2,800 Crore).

Context : Sustainability as a rising global and national trend.

Figure 11 The Ideate Tab in the Game Arena

2.7 Prototype

In this tab, participants are tasked with developing prototypes based on their chosen ideas from the ideation page. They must decide on the features to include, such as aesthetics, battery life, language support, and technology integration. While selecting these features, participants should consider fluctuations in unit costs and the affordability of the target group, ensuring they maintain the product's value proposition without compromise.

Prototype | Execute | Decision Checklist | Report | Synopsis

Food For Thought

Prototype

TechTime Linguist

Battery Life, %: 60

- Design & Aesthetics
- Localized Language Support
- Seamless Syncing
- Water Resistance
- Customizable Watch Faces
- Unique Health Features
- Indian Payment System Integration

Capability Level	80
Unit Cost, INR	16,946
Battery days	1.41
Localization, %	29

TechTime Dharma

Battery Life, %: 70

- Design & Aesthetics
- Localized Language Support
- Seamless Syncing
- Water Resistance
- Customizable Watch Faces
- Unique Health Features
- Indian Payment System Integration

Capability Level	97
Unit Cost, INR	23,473
Battery days	0.95
Localization, %	26

TechTime PayBharat

Battery Life, %: 70

- Design & Aesthetics
- Localized Language Support
- Seamless Syncing
- Water Resistance
- Customizable Watch Faces
- Unique Health Features
- Indian Payment System Integration

Capability Level	82
Unit Cost, INR	14,674
Battery days	0.95
Localization, %	29

Figure 12 The Prototype Tab in the Game Arena

2.8 Execute

In the execute page, the participants are tasked with taking decision on the Marketing Mix for the product including the Price, advertising, Warranty period as well as decision on channel investment.

The four channels to consider for product sales include:

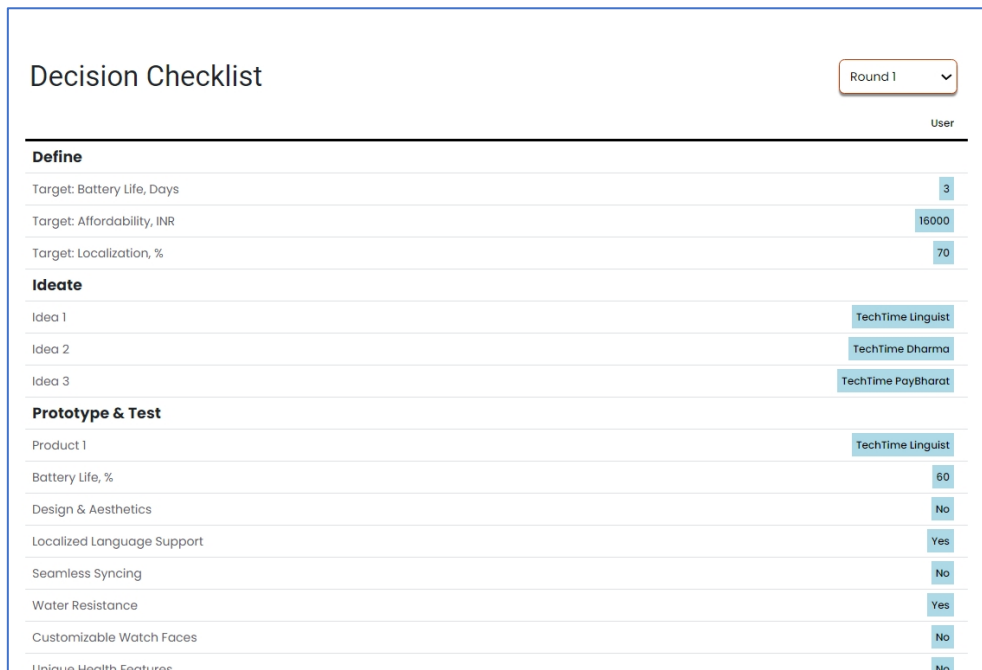
1. **Distributor/Wholesaler:** This channel facilitates bulk sales to intermediaries who distribute products to various retailers, enhancing market reach and efficiency.
2. **E-commerce:** Selling through online platforms allows access to a broad customer base with lower operational costs and the ability to track consumer behaviour.
3. **Telecom Partnerships:** Collaborating with telecom companies enables products to be bundled with mobile plans, increasing visibility and accessibility to their customer base.
4. **Direct-to-Consumer:** This approach involves selling products directly to consumers, allowing for greater control over branding and customer experience while improving profit margins.



Figure 13 The Execute Tab in the Game Arena

2.9 Decision Checklist

The Decision Checklist helps participants review and finalize their decisions. Once decisions are confirmed, they can submit them using the "Submit" option and choose **save and proceed**. It's important to note that once decisions are submitted and saved, they cannot be altered for that round. This ensures that decisions are carefully considered before finalization, promoting clarity and accountability in the decision-making process.



Decision Checklist		Round 1	User
Define			
Target: Battery Life, Days		3	
Target: Affordability, INR		16000	
Target: Localization, %		70	
Ideate			
Idea 1		TechTime Linguist	
Idea 2		TechTime Dharm	
Idea 3		TechTime PayBharat	
Prototype & Test			
Product 1		TechTime Linguist	
Battery Life, %		60	
Design & Aesthetics		No	
Localized Language Support		Yes	
Seamless Syncing		No	
Water Resistance		Yes	
Customizable Watch Faces		No	
Unique Health Features		No	

Figure 14 The Decision Checklist in the Game Arena

2.10 Report

- The report section provides the details on the participants' critical thinking abilities. It demonstrates how their thought process influenced the outcomes, providing insights into the impact of their decision-making skills.

This section consists of feedback on the performance of the participant based on four metrics.

- Rigour:** Consistency throughout the decision-making and recommendation.
- Structuring:** Logical approach of gathering and analysing information
- Synthesis:** Approach towards interpreting information and making informed decisions
- Business Judgement:** Ability to evaluate facts, and consider risks and possible implications when making decision.



Figure 15 The Report in the Game Arena

The income statement in the report provides a detailed overview of the revenue generated from product sales, along with various costs associated with production, administration, and marketing efforts. The graph adjacent outlines the resulting operating profit or loss, the attractiveness score of the product, market share captured, as well as the total units sold.

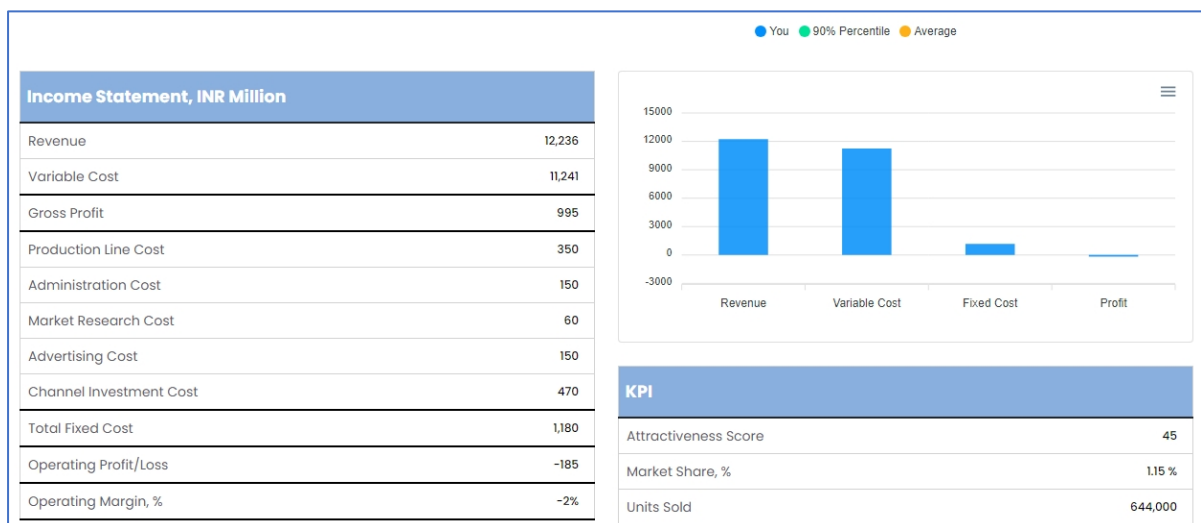


Figure 16 The Income Statement- Report in the Game Arena

The report includes product details that highlight the features added and their alignment with market needs, along with tips for market expansion. It assesses the product's market attractiveness, indicating whether differentiation or the achievement of unique selling propositions (USPs) is necessary. Participants must identify what sets their product apart, amplify these attributes in promotions, and consider increasing investment in distribution channels to enhance market presence. They should also focus on improving key performance indicators (KPIs), operating margins, and market share in upcoming rounds.

Product	
Features	TechTime Linguist
Battery days	1.41
Localization, %	29%
Warranty Period	12 months
Design & Aesthetics	0
Localized Language Support	1
Seamless Syncing	0
Water Resistance	1
Customizable Watch Faces	0
Unique Health Features	0
Indian Payment System Integration	0
Tip to Product Fit & Expansion	Tip to Market Fit & Expansion
"The instant translation feature is a lifesaver for those of us who travel within India frequently. However, the cultural event reminders seem limited to a few major events." Future Want: "More comprehensive coverage of regional festivals and events would be appreciated."	Moderate attractiveness. The product is at the market's average level, indicating it's on the right track but needs differentiation. Focus on unique selling propositions (USPs). What can set your product apart? Amplify that in promotions and possibly invest more in distribution channels.

Figure 17 The Product Details - Report in the Game Arena

2.11 Synopsis

The synopsis section provides a condensed overview of the key decision areas and outcomes. It offers participants a quick reference point to grasp the essence of their decisions and their thinking ability, aiding in holistic understanding and future planning.

Round 1 XLS

Synopsis

Input		Income Statement, INR Million	
Parameters	Input	Parameter	Output
Target: Battery Life, Days	3	Revenue	12,236
Target: Affordability, INR	16000	Variable Cost	11,241
Target: Localization, %	70%	Gross Profit	995
Idea 1	TechTime Linguist	Production Line Cost	350
Idea 2	TechTime Dharma	Administration Cost	150
Idea 3	TechTime PayBharat	Market Research Cost	60
Product 1	TechTime Linguist	Advertising Cost	150
Battery Life	60%	Channel Investment Cost	470
Design & Aesthetics	No	Total Fixed Cost	1,180
Localized Language Support	Yes	Operating Profit/Loss	-185
Seamless Syncing	No		
Water Resistance	Yes		
Customizable Watch Faces	No		
Unique Health Features	No		
Indian Payment System Integration	No		
Product 2	TechTime Dharma		
Battery Life	70%		

KPI	
Parameter	Output
Attractiveness Score	45
Market Share, %	1%
Units Sold	64
Operating Margin, %	-3%

Round 2

Figure 18 The Synopsis in the Game Arena

To proceed to the next iteration, follow these steps:

1. Navigate to the end of the synopsis page to locate the link for the next round.
2. Click on the 'Round' to advance to the next round.
3. You will be redirected to the home page.
4. Click on the card to begin the next round.